10-05 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Yawn — and Why Do Yawns Seem to Jump from One Person to Another?

① It is ten o'clock at night. Your mother yawns while washing the last bowl. Two seconds later, you yawn too — without thinking about it. A moment after that, even the cat stretches its mouth into a wide, funny yawn. One action, quietly passed across a room. We have all seen this happen. But **why do humans yawn at all, and why do yawns seem to spread like a quiet smile?**

② A yawn is a long, deep breath. When you yawn, you open your mouth wide, take in a great deal of air through both the mouth and the nose, and let it out slowly. At the same time, the muscles in your face, neck and chest stretch for a few seconds. A yawn may last only 6 or 7 seconds, but it gives the body a small, complete "reset".

③ For a long time, people said that yawning happens because the blood needs more oxygen, and the brain is telling the body to breathe deeply. This is partly true, but not the whole story. Modern scientists now believe yawning has a second and more interesting job: **it helps cool down the brain**. Just like a computer, a hard-working brain grows warm. When you pull in a large mouth of cool air, the air flows past blood vessels in your face, and the blood returning to the brain is a little cooler. A cool brain thinks faster and feels more awake. That is why we often yawn right before a test, a speech, or an important match — not because we are bored, but because the brain is getting ready to work.

④ Yawning is also strongly tied to **the time of day**. We yawn most often right after waking up and right before going to sleep — the two moments when the brain most needs to switch gears. Long, quiet classrooms, warm cars, and heavy afternoon lessons also bring on yawns, because in those moments the brain is fighting to stay alert.

⑤ But the most curious thing about yawning is this: **yawns are catching**. Seeing another person yawn, hearing someone yawn over the phone, or even reading a paragraph about yawning (like the one you are reading right now) can make *you* yawn. About 60—70 percent of people catch yawns this way. Even more surprising, dogs that live closely with humans also catch human yawns.

⑥ Why? Scientists believe "catching a yawn" is connected to **empathy** — the ability to feel what another person feels. Your brain has special cells called *mirror neurons* that quietly copy what you see others do. When a stranger yawns on a train, your mirror

neurons gently echo the action, and you follow. Studies have shown that people catch yawns more easily from close friends and family than from strangers, because the closer we feel to someone, the more sensitive our mirror neurons are to them.

⑦ So yawning is not just a sign of a sleepy person. It is a short cooling break for a busy brain, a small signal that your body is switching gears, and even a quiet proof that humans — and dogs — are connected to one another in invisible ways. Next time your little brother yawns at the dinner table and you find your own mouth opening, try to remember: you have just used some of the oldest, most social cells in your head.

注释： blood vessel 血管；switch gears 转换状态；catch a yawn 传染性打哈欠；empathy 同理心；mirror neuron 镜像神经元

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What does the writer mean by calling a yawn a "reset" in Paragraph 2?

A. A yawn restarts the computer on your desk.
B. A yawn is a 6—7 second deep breath that stretches face, neck and chest muscles and briefly refreshes the body.
C. A yawn returns your age to zero.
D. A yawn forces the body to fall asleep at once.

2. According to the article, what is now believed to be a main purpose of yawning?

A. To fill the stomach with air.
B. To help cool the brain, so it can think faster and stay awake.
C. To make our voices deeper.
D. To show boredom to friends.

3. Why might a student yawn right before a big test, according to the article?

A. Because tests are boring and uninteresting.
B. Because the brain is tired and wants to sleep.
C. Because the brain is getting ready to work hard and wants to cool down and wake up.
D. Because yawning gives more points in the exam.

4. What is the most surprising thing about yawns, according to the writer?

A. They last several minutes.
B. Only cats can catch them.
C. They are "catching" — about 60—70 percent of people yawn after seeing or hearing someone else yawn, even by reading about it.
D. They can be stopped completely by drinking water.

5. What does the last paragraph mainly tell us?

A. Yawning is only a sign of being bored.
B. Yawning is a small, clever action that cools the brain, signals a gear-change, and quietly shows that humans and even dogs are connected.
C. Only children should yawn, not adults.
D. Yawning is dangerous and should be avoided.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】词义猜测题
【定位】第②段 "A yawn may last only 6 or 7 seconds, but it gives the body a small, complete 'reset'."
【解析】"reset" 指深呼吸 + 肌肉伸展，让身体短暂刷新。A 字面上机、C "年龄归零"、D "立即入睡"均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "yawning has a second and more interesting job: it helps cool down the brain."
【解析】现代科学认为打哈欠主要作用之一是为大脑降温。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第③段末 "we often yawn right before a test ... not because we are bored, but because the brain is getting ready to work"
【解析】考前打哈欠是大脑在"点火降温"而非无聊。A、B、D 均误解原文。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "yawns are catching ... About 60—70 percent of people catch yawns this way."
【解析】哈欠具有传染性是最令人惊奇的特点。A 时长不符、B "只有猫"、D "喝水就停"均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦段 "Yawning is not just a sign of a sleepy person. It is a short cooling break

... quiet proof that humans — and dogs — are connected to one another in invisible ways."

【解析】末段综合总结三个要点。A 片面、C、D 与原文相反。故选 B。